

It is the traffic controller's responsibility to set up the PREPARE TO STOP and the Traffic Controller (Symbolic) signs prior to works and remove them at the end of works. This can only be done by, or under the guidance of, a person holding appropriate accreditation.

If traffic control is taken over part way through a shift, the traffic controller must check that both signs are properly set up at the start of their shift.

The position of the PREPARE TO STOP sign, portable traffic signal or boom barrier and Traffic Controller (symbolic) sign is according to the local prevailing conditions and speed, and placed a minimum distance from the end of traffic queue, as outlined in Table 2.3. Detailed steps and calculations associated with assigning appropriate sight distances are described in detail in Austroads Guide to Road Design Part 3 and Part 4a. Where there is the potential for long traffic queues, consider the use of repeater signs ahead of the worksite to inform road users of upcoming road conditions.

Table 2.3: Prepare to Stop/Traffic Controller (symbolic) sign position from end of traffic queue

Speed (km/h)*	Minimum Distance (m)
≤ 45	50
46 - 55	70
56 - 65	90
≥ 66	Two times the speed of traffic (km/h)

* Choose speed as per Figure 2.6. For example, if signs are positioned in the green zone, use distance which corresponds to a speed of 110 km/h in Table 2.3. If signs are positioned in the yellow zone, use distance which corresponds to a speed 80 km/h, 60 km/h for the blue zone and so on.

Figure 2.6: Appropriate speed use for sign placement



2.8 Performing Traffic Control

2.8.1 Traffic signals

A traffic controller cannot direct traffic through traffic signals without having the relevant authority to switch the traffic signals to flashing amber or off. Worksite supervisors must first gain the written approval of the relevant road infrastructure manager to switch traffic signals to flashing amber or off.